

- **Describe an experience when you deliberately pushed yourself beyond your comfort zone.**
- **What did you learn from that experience?**

When I was in grade 10, I was 15 and I could walk, then, the covid-19 lockdowns happened, and my family took it quite seriously. At the end of grade 11 me, my parents and my grandparents were still in quarantine from covid-19, I was 16 and relied on wheelchair to get around. My mom asked me if I wanted to go back to school in-person for my grade 12 year. To most especially after a year and a half of quarantine it would be expected to rejoice in the opportunity to choose my own fate as it seemed. yet I couldn't or didn't want to accept the fact that my friends would see that my life had irreparably and substantially changed as I was a fulltime wheelchair user now. When my mom asked me originally, I answered no to the prospect of going to school and establishing a social life again out of fear and cowardice, I say cowardice as I knew exactly what I had to do to save the trouble of my time in quarantine becoming a far deeper pit by hiding myself away and knowing that I did it to myself by choice. And so about midway through the summer I registered to attend my last year in person. I was terrified not of being made fun of as I had a very good reputation among the school and peers, what I was afraid of was not being useful. What I experienced going back to school was pure encouragement and an understanding not of how I felt but of the fact I was not going to roll over and allow my disease to win. I received respect from both other students and the teachers, I was popular, I won prom king, and I got a standing ovation at graduation. My fears almost denied this from happening and I learned to conquer fear; challenges with courage.

Utility is probably the main thing I have always struggled with as I have 2 older brothers 5 and 10 years older who were both talented, competitive, and team-oriented hockey players and general athletes. Plus, there both amazing supportive brothers and people so it's a lot to live up to. I always looked for my father's approval as I felt he was not to impressed with me and favored athletic achievement.